Add the MySQL Connector driver manually

1. Open the MySQL Connector/J download page.

https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/connector/j/

2. Choose Version 26.7.0, Platform Independent and download the ZIP archive. If prompted to sign in, choose No thanks, just start my download.
3. Extract the ZIP into a permanent folder, such as a lib folder inside your Java project.
4. In IntelliJ, open File → Project Structure → Modules → Dependencies.
5. Click + → JARs or Directories.
6. Select the extracted mysql-connector-j-<version>.jar file—not the ZIP.
7. Leave its scope as Compile, then click Apply → OK.